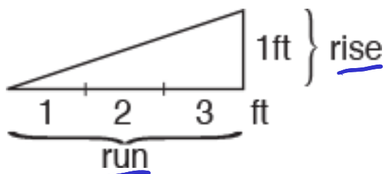
Rise Over Run

Slope refers to the amount of incline, slant, or steepness. Ski runs, most roofs, and the graphs of linear equations have slope.

Slope is a ratio that compares the **rise** of an incline to the **run**.

Look at the ramp. The rise is 1 foot, the vertical distance. The run is 3 feet, the horizontal distance. The slope of the ramp is 1:3. This means that for every foot of vertical distance (rise), there are 3 feet of horizontal distance (run).

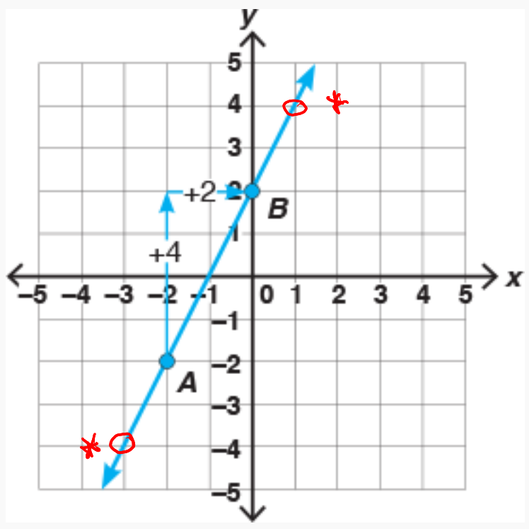


Example

Hide

Find the slope of the line shown on the graph.

Choose any two points on the line. Points *A* and *B* are used here.



* also would be good points to use.

$$\text{Slope} = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1} = \frac{2-(-2)}{0-(-2)} = \frac{2+2}{2} = \frac{4}{2}$$

so slope = 2

Step 1

Count the rise and the run.

To get from *A* to *B*, you would go up 4 units and go right 2 units. The rise is 4, and the run is 2.

Step 2

Write the slope ratio.

The slope of the line is $\frac{4}{2}$, which equals **2.**

Key Terms

- **rise**
- **run**
- **slope**
- **undefined**

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Lesson 2: Slope

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